

Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

Rainy Day, Shiny Things

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: gratitude.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

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For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

Even on a grey, boring day there are good things around us. Noticing them and saying thank you helps us feel happier.

The big line

“Every day, rainy or sunny, has something special.”

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
grumpy	in a bad mood, cross	fold your arms and frown
shiny	bright and sparkly in the light	flick your fingers open like sparkles
notice	to see something you didn’t see before	point to your eyes
thankful	happy about something good you have	hands on your heart
soothing	calming and gentle	stroke your arm slowly

A gentle note

Being grumpy is allowed. Gratitude is about noticing good things, not pretending everything is fine.

Real-life safety: broken glass is dangerous. Children should never touch it; they should step away and tell a grown-up.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Whiskers

House cat

A cat who learns to be thankful on a rainy day



Mittens

House cat (orange tabby)

Whiskers' playful housemate



Shadow

House cat (tuxedo)

The quiet black-and-white housemate



The butterfly

Monarch butterfly

Flutters by the window

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How did they feel?

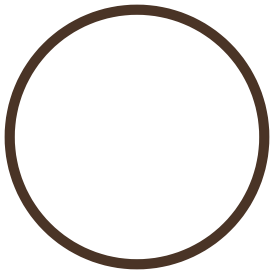
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

Mrs. Maple tucks the cats in every night. How does Mrs.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

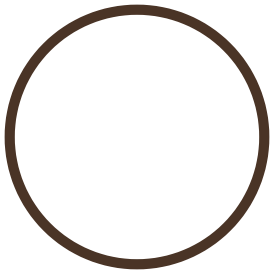


Moment 2

A crash! The pieces sparkle like stars. What happened to the cats'

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

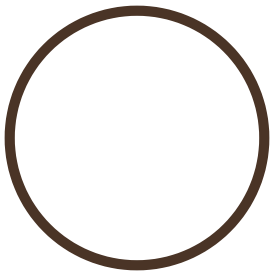


Moment 3

Now the rain sounds soothing.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



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Story in order

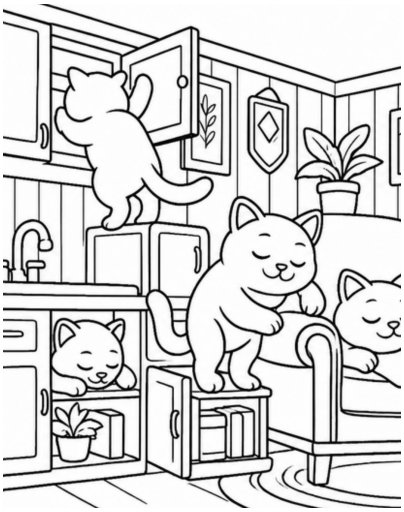
Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

grumpy in a bad mood, cross

grumpy grumpy

shiny bright and sparkly in the light

shiny shiny

notice to see something you didn't see before

notice notice

Whiskers the hero of the story

Whiskers Whiskers

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Whiskers showed gratitude. Draw a time when you showed gratitude too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Thank-you without words

You need: None

Like the cats, find ways to say thank you without words: a smile, a high five, a helping hand, a drawing. Partners take turns guessing what the ‘thank you’ is for.

Thankful window

On a rainy day, look out the window and name three things you're thankful for.

Shiny hunt

Find three shiny things around the house. Which one is your favourite?

Whisker test

Gently blow on the back of your hand. Cats can feel tiny puffs of air like that with their whiskers.

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in Rainy Day, Shiny Things are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Whiskers

House cat

Most cats have 24 whiskers, 12 on each side of the face.



Mittens

House cat (orange tabby)

The word 'tabby' comes from striped silk once made in Baghdad.



Shadow

House cat (tuxedo)

A gene called the white spotting gene makes the white patches.



The butterfly

Monarch butterfly

Milkweed makes monarchs taste bad, so an animal that eats one feels sick and leaves them alone after.

Story or real?

Real cats can't say thank you, but they do show how they feel, with purrs, slow blinks and the way they hold their tails.

Where they really live

The book happens at home, so for a place to visit we followed the butterfly. We picked Point Pelee, where thousands of monarchs rest on their way to Mexico.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/rainy-day-shiny-things

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

How many cats can you see? What is the weather like?

Rainy Day, Shiny Things, talk card 1

Why were the cats grumpy on the rainy day?

Rainy Day, Shiny Things, talk card 2

What changed their mood?

Rainy Day, Shiny Things, talk card 3

How did the cats say thank you to Mrs. Maple without words?

Rainy Day, Shiny Things, talk card 4

What is one special thing that happened today?

Rainy Day, Shiny Things, talk card 5

Who looks after you? How could you show them thanks?

Rainy Day, Shiny Things, talk card 6

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Gratitude hero

This is to say that

_____

showed gratitude, just like Whiskers.

Signed _____ Date _____

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